

So I recently found out how ChatGPT is bad for the environment and I need help adjusting to not using it

Posted by u/Lucky_AfterDark • 0 points • 8 comments

I used to use chatgpt for a lot of things. Most importantly help planning and mental help. It was really good at helping me plan stuff and create a step by step process since my autism makes it harder for me to do stuff without it. Also whenever I felt awful or suicidal, I talked to it and it helped.

Now since I've stopped using it lately, I've been having a hard time with doing stuff without it. I have many things I need to make a plan for, and a list for. And I've also been feeling depressed and in a rough spot, and could use some time to talk to it (therapists are too expensive. I'm not getting one unless I become rich all of a sudden).

So I need help adjusting to life without it. With knowing how to plan things and make lists, to how to deal with mental health.

Comments

u/AlternativeLie9486 • 1 points • 2025-08-04 23:16 UTC

I'm curious why you believe it's bad for the environment. And if you are basing it of energy consumption, are there not many other things you could reduce or give up instead to balance things out?

u/JustAwesome360 • 1 points • 2025-08-04 22:46 UTC

Keep using it. Honestly you're the one person who seems to really make proper use of it. It's helping make your life better. Unlike most people who just want it to do their homework for them or make a picture of a monkey with a minigun.

u/Hour-Awareness-9198 • 1 points • 2025-08-04 22:26 UTC

Honestly, AI is going to become a tool everyone will have to eventually get used to using. It's either use it, or get replaced by it.

Environment is the least of someone's concerns if they have been over reliant on it. For example, I know people who use ChatGPT for practically every task, even writing emails. Which diminishes their

abilities over time.

As time goes on, LLM will become more environmentally friendly. You do not want to risk being left behind. Use AI more strategically and make sure your abilities are not compromised as you use it.

You can also use alternative AIs which specialise in things. For VS code, you can use Co Pilot for GitHub. When writing notes, you can use Gemini. If you want to brainstorm some ideas, use Claude. There's specialised usages for each AI.

It's good to care for the environment, but make sure you are not left behind and become obsolete.

u/King_job0 • 1 points • 2025-08-04 22:25 UTC

I take a more cynical approach to this technology. It's not chatgpt itself that's bad for the environment it's how we collect and use electricity that destroys the environment. You have to look at the trade offs and look out for yourself first. One person is never going to have a dramatic enough impact on the environment to make any difference and the companies destroying the environment will continue regardless of what you do.

Beyond that if you want to supplement your reliance on chatgpt you should look to build up other resources that teach these skills and find a support group that would be able and willing to help you. There are videos on YouTube and books that can teach you how to manage yourself and other friends and family will be willing to help you if you feel down. If you need someone to chat I could also help as much as reasonably possible just dm me.

Hope you have a good one :)

u/Lucky_AfterDark • 1 points • 2025-08-04 22:33 UTC

Thank you, I'll try finding tutorials for that! Have a good day as well!

u/Sad-Mountain7232 • 1 points • 2025-08-04 22:22 UTC

Going cold turkey may not be the best option. Try doing one thing on your own not using ChatGPT and then when you feel comfortable doing that, try another. Might have more success that way and your intentions are good, so don't feel about about slowly weeding off it instead of all at once.

u/Lucky_AfterDark • 1 points • 2025-08-04 22:31 UTC

That seems like a good idea. It's just, I want to plan a trip somewhere and I have no clue what to do and the event happening during the trip is soon, so I'm trying to rush through this. Do you have any advice on how to plan for that?

u/Sad-Mountain7232 • 1 points • 2025-08-04 22:41 UTC

Back in the 1990's, we used the Rand McNally software on our computer to map the drive and find the destination spots lol. Now, there is Google. Not quite as efficient at ChatGPT but even if you type "Plan Trip" in Google, there are other applications that can assist you. There is no guarantee that they don't use high-powered AI for their tool though lol